

To go open-source or not?

Dear Karan,
The January 2002 issue of Digit was extremely interesting and useful. But, what caught my eye was Varun's letter in the Letters section and your response to it. I am still not convinced by your reply.

The remedy you suggested (of using open-source software) is not that simple to implement. Why would I want to use Gnome-editor to make my resume, when my potential employer runs MS-Office XP? Sure, there is conversion software etc, but he would first open my competitor's CV, which has been developed in MS Office 2000. So I

lose the race in the first step itself! Any user, when he chooses software, not only has to consider his requirements and capability, but also external entities and compatibility related issues that may crop up.

Don't get me wrong. I am not at all in favour of piracy. I am against the attitude of software giants, who initially create worldwide standards by being pro-user, then use these to dictate their own terms. This is as unrealistic in a cost-conscious society as petrol being costlier than the car it runs.

S. BALGURU

Via e-mail

digit

Hi,

When you say that application software that are sold today are overpriced, you are right. Forking out Rs 20,000 for the latest version of Microsoft Office might make little sense for a person who only occasionally needs to type out a few documents at home.

But when you claim that piracy is the only option available to you because no reasonable alternative exists you are mistaken.

Other office suites from Lotus and Corel have been around for years and offer a comparable feature set at a fraction of the price. You can get a license for Lotus Smart Suite Millennium edition for about Rs 6,000.

In addition to these 'commercial' products, you also have the choice of using WordPad (free with windows) which can be used to create a pretty spiffy resume.

And each of the free/commercial alternatives (like Star Office) also allow you to save your resume as an RTF (Rich Text) document which is a long established standard supported by every word processor that I can remember, including Microsoft Word.

The point is that alternatives do exist. They might not be exactly what you want, and might lack some features that you want, but they are out there.

Don't like no Quake!

Dear Digit,

Your January issue was great, except for one article—'15 essentials for a diehard gamer'. In this article you've named only a bunch of violent games (with the exception of Need For Speed 4 and Tetris). There are many gamers like me who prefer sports or simulations. Any such list you make in the future should include games that can be played by all age groups.

ANIRBAN CHATTOPADHYAY

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Anirban,

The games that we included were the ones that we found relevant to our time and age. While every genre has its own set of followers, action games are favoured by the majority of PC gamers. If you were to try and list the most innovative titles today, they would largely be 3D accelerated action games. The most anticipated PC titles in 2002 are Unreal II and DOOM III. The simulation and

sports genres on the other hand have been stagnating in both numbers and innovation for the last few years. They offer little beyond minimal cosmetic upgrades and updated team rosters (in the case of sports games). Yes, we didn't have too many sports titles, simulations or adventure games in our listing. Perhaps, if we had a Top 30 games list, you would have seen some of your favourite titles.

Send your letters marked 'Readers Letters' to the Digit office:

D-222/2, MIDC, TTC Industrial Estate, Om Sagar Building, Nerul, Navi Mumbai 400 706,

Phone: 022-7629191/9200; Fax: 022-7629224

E-mail: readersletters@jasubhai.com

Goof Ups

■ **Software missing in action!** The CD cover of the January 2002 issue of Digit mentions Ulead Cool 3D 3.5 as one of the software in the multimedia section. But we failed to actually carry it. Our apologies for the inconvenience caused. Thanks Vijay Samuel, for pointing this out to us.

■ **Our apologies.** In the Zero1 awards featured in the December 2001 issue of Digit, we printed the price of the Maxtor D540X 80 GB hard disk as Rs 4,490. It stands at Rs 11,500.

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

Short Bytes

Guns and Roses

Wow! What an interesting and gripping January 2002 issue of Digit. The software collection on the CD was excellent, as was the Hands-On tutorial on 'Speeding up and upgrading your PC'. I could easily spend a couple of months, nay a full year even, trying to digest all the information in the magazine. My heartiest congratulations, and at the same time apologies for using so many superlatives but there was no other way to describe your mammoth effort.

ANIL SARWAL

Via e-mail

Hi,

First of all, congratulations on another superb issue of Digit. How do you manage this guys? I barely manage to get our college magazine out on time, and quality is another thing. What motivates you people?

Could you include Counterstrike v1.3 on your next CD?

KRISHNA KUMAR

Via e-mail